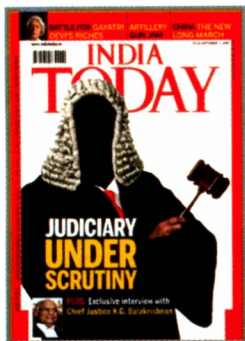


# Judiciary Under Scrutiny

SEPTEMBER 7, 2009

Under mounting pressure, Supreme Court judges decide to reveal their assets but radical reforms are required in the judiciary to restore credibility and accountability.



“ The judiciary is accountable to no-one but itself, but to uphold the sanctity, credibility and independence of the judicial process, it should also enforce the responsibility of self-correction. ”

J. AKSHAY, *Secunderabad*

## Overhaul Needed

Judicial reforms are long overdue (“Lords on Trial”, September 7). Apart from the fact that there is a huge backlog of cases, the judiciary has become ridden with corruption. There can be no earthly logic to explain why our honourable judges should be exempt from declaring their assets. This lack of transparency breeds corruption. Similarly, steps ought to be taken to ensure speedy disposal of cases pending in various courts. How can the judges afford to go on vacations? They, in fact, need to work overtime to clear the huge backlog.

AMBAR MALLICK, *Kolkata*

There is no denying the fact that our judiciary, including some of those in higher positions, have



## Statue Moves

The coming together of the chief ministers of Tamil Nadu and Karnataka for unveiling the statues of a Tamil saint in Bangalore and a Kannada saint in Chennai recently exhibits strong political will (“Patriarch on the Offensive”, September 7). Both M. Karunanidhi and B.S. Yeddyurappa overlooked their ideological and political differences. Their camaraderie clearly reinforced the fact that an amicable solution to any problem can be found only through trust and meaningful dialogues. They have set a precedent.

K.R. SRINIVASAN, *Secunderabad*

By unveiling the statue of Thiruvalluvar, Yeddyurappa has done the impossible. Sharing the dais with Karunanidhi has not just helped him gain political mileage but could serve a larger purpose as well: bridge the gap between the BJP and the DMK.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM, *Thiruvananthapuram*

fallen prey to corruption, and the belief that judges can also be bought and their decisions influenced has been steadily gaining ground. Some of the instances cited in the article are shocking to the extreme. The only solution to this menace is transparency and more transparency. The judges should do their bit in restoring common man's faith in judiciary.

R.J. KHURANA, *Bhopal*

## Troubled Past

The real tragedy is not that Indians have been unable to see Mohammad Ali Jinnah differently, as some secular historians would make us believe, but that we still hold rose-tinted notions about undivided India (“Who's to Blame?”, August 31). An undivided India on

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